example, the Western Meadowlark (*Sturnella neglecta*) and Eastern Meadowlark (*Sturnella magna*) look similar and have overlapping ranges, but they have evolved to produce different songs. This prevents them from mating with each other, making them two distinct species.

Another scenario is when members of the same species look very different, but because they can mate and reproduce they are still considered to be the same species. The most obvious instance of this is the domestic dog (*Canis familiaris*), a species in which there are great differences between individuals. However, as is also evident, different breeds are capable of reproduction with each other, and therefore belong to the same species.

Complex permutations

According to the biological species concept, the potential for inter-breeding and producing fertile offspring is key to the definition of a species. Geographical separation alone does not prevent species from reproducing if they are brought together. Evolutionary divergences—such as the different mating songs of the Western and Eastern Meadowlarks—are what prevents interbreeding.

The biological species concept is not applicable to organisms that reproduce asexually such as bacteria, or asexual creatures—for example, species of whiptail lizard. Sometimes, too, different animal species are able to mate and produce offspring. This is the case of a female horse (*Equus ferus caballus*) and a male donkey (*Equus africanus asinus*), which together can produce a hybrid: the mule. Mules are generally incapable of reproduction, therefore the horse and donkey remain different species. In zoos, however, female tigers and male lions can reproduce to produce a liger, which can sometimes be fertile.